

Debian WiFi: Disable Power Save

Device: Generic | Interface: wlan0 | OS: Debian

Step 1 – Check Your Interface Name

wlan0 is common but Debian may use a different name. Run:

```
ip link show
```

Look for your wireless interface. It may be something like wlp2s0 or wlp3s0. Use that name in place of wlan0 in the commands below.

Step 2 – Disable Power Saving Immediately

Run this command (replace wlan0 with your interface name if different):

```
sudo iw dev wlan0 set power_save off
```

Verify it worked:

```
iw dev wlan0 get power_save
```

Should return: Power save: off

Step 3 – Make It Permanent

Create a NetworkManager config file:

```
sudo nano /etc/NetworkManager/conf.d/wifi-powersave.conf
```

Add the following contents to the file:

```
[connection]
wifi.powersave = 2
```

Save with Ctrl+O, then exit with Ctrl+X.

Step 4 – Restart NetworkManager

```
sudo systemctl restart NetworkManager
```

Reference

wifi.powersave values: 2 = power save off (what you want), 3 = power save on (default).

This fix ensures consistent full-power WiFi whether docked or on battery.

Debian WiFi: Disable Power Save

Device: Panasonic FZ-G1 | Interface: wlp1s0 | OS: Debian

Step 1 — Identify Your Wireless Interface

Run the following to list network interfaces:

```
ip link show
```

In this case the wireless interface was identified as wlp1s0 (not the common wlan0). Use whatever your system returns in all subsequent commands.

Step 2 — Disable Power Save

Run with sudo since iw lives in /usr/sbin which requires elevated access:

```
sudo iw dev wlp1s0 set power_save off
```

This command ran without error confirming it applied successfully.

Step 3 — Verify Power Save Is Off

Attempting to verify immediately failed because /usr/sbin was not in the regular user PATH:

```
iw dev wlp1s0 get power_save
```

Result: bash: iw: command not found

iw was confirmed installed at the correct version (6.9-1) but located at /usr/sbin/iw which was outside the default user PATH. Running with the full path worked:

```
/sbin/iw dev wlp1s0 get power_save
```

Result: Power save: off

Step 4 — Fix the PATH for Regular User Sessions

Export the missing paths for the current session:

```
export PATH=$PATH:/sbin:/usr/sbin
```

Then make it permanent by appending to .bashrc:

```
echo 'export PATH=$PATH:/usr/sbin:/sbin' >> ~/.bashrc  
source ~/.bashrc
```

After this, iw commands work without sudo or full path for the regular user.

Step 5 — Make Power Save Permanently Off

Create a NetworkManager config file:

```
sudo nano /etc/NetworkManager/conf.d/wifi-powersave.conf
```

Add the following contents:

```
[connection]  
wifi.powersave = 2
```

Save with Ctrl+O and exit with Ctrl+X. Then restart NetworkManager:

```
sudo systemctl restart NetworkManager
```

wifi.powersave values: 2 = off (full power), 3 = on (default power saving)

Result

WiFi power saving is now disabled permanently. The adapter runs at full power whether on battery or docked, resolving the signal drop when undocked.